

Boundary Value Analysis

A technique focused on boundaries between partitions, where defects are often found.

Idea

Test values exactly at the boundary and immediately below/above when applicable.

Example

For range 18–65, consider 17, 18, 19, 64, 65 and 66 depending on rule and risk.

Applications

Numeric fields, dates, sizes, quantities, pagination, upload limits and thresholds.

Combination

Use with equivalence partitioning and business rules rather than mechanically listing numbers.

When to use it

Use this knowledge when product risk, architecture or the delivery stage requires this type of validation. Confirm the goal, environment, required data and expected evidence before starting.

How QA applies it

Start from the behavior or risk to validate, prepare data and environment, execute the technique or tool reproducibly and capture evidence that helps the team understand the result.

QA tip

Boundaries are not only numbers: dates, states, quantities and transitions also have edges.